



AI Smartphones

When phones started thinking instead of just processing

A I on smartphones has shifted from being a buzzword to something that quietly shapes everyday use, summarising calls, fixing photos, organising information or multitasking. Over weeks of testing across brands, the real difference wasn't in how many AI tools manufacturers listed on their spec sheets, but in how consistently those tools worked in real-world scenarios. This year's Digit Zero1 award winners earned their spots by being reliable, practical and genuinely helpful, not just clever on paper.

Zero1 winner: Samsung Galaxy S25 Ultra

The Galaxy S25 Ultra comes out on top largely because its AI features feel the most stable and refined. Most tools run locally on the Snapdragon 8 Elite for Galaxy, so actions like object removal or webpage summaries happen quickly without delays.

Generative Edit proved useful for routine edits, removing clutter, straightening compositions or expanding frames. Circle to Search also became a dependable utility while researching stories or identifying objects during field work. Samsung's ProVisual Engine 2.0 handled low-light photos with better judgement, especially with noise and colour control.

Features like Audio Eraser and live call translation are not revolutionary, but they worked consistently enough to be worth using. The S25 Ultra does not try to overwhelm you with AI, it simply integrates it cleanly into tasks you already do, which is ultimately why it leads this category.



Samsung Galaxy S25 Ultra
Price: ₹1,29,999

Runner-up: OnePlus 13s

The OnePlus 13s lands closely behind. Its approach to AI leans more toward productivity and organisation, and that showed in testing. The Plus Key was handy, offering quick access to tools like AI Plus Mind, which saved snippets, screenshots or articles and made them easy to search.

AI Call Assistant and VoiceScribe stood out. They handled summaries and translations well across regular calls and platforms like WhatsApp and Zoom. The photo tools Unblur, Reframe and Reflection Eraser sometimes gave uneven results but were helpful for quick fixes.



OnePlus 13s
Price: ₹54,999

Best Buy: Realme 15 Pro

Realme's 15 Pro earns the Best Buy award by offering a wide AI toolset at a mid-range price without being gimmicky. AI Edit Genie was the standout, with simple voice commands for photo edits helping users who don't want to fiddle with manual tools.

Modes like AI Party Mode, MagicGlow 2.0 and Landscape Enhancement showed improvements in conditions where mid-range phones typically fall short, such as low light or cloudy outdoor shots. On the performance front, AI-driven optimisations for gaming and multitasking kept the phone responsive under load, helped by the Snapdragon 7 Gen 4's capable NPU.

— Ashish Singh | editor@digit.in



Realme 15 Pro
Price: ₹31,999